and commenting to another, “Yes, it’s the compensation for moving away from my hut near the test site—a few more postponements and I can build a house of my own...”.

Another cartoonist designated Agni as “ IDBM—Intermittently Delayed Bal istic Missile.” Amul’s cartoon suggested that what Agni needed to do was use their butter as fuel!

I took some time off, leaving my team at ITR to talk to the DRDLRCI community. The entire DRDL-RCI community assembled after working hours on 8 May 1989. I addressed the gathering of more than 2,000 persons, “Very rarely is a laboratory or an R&D establishment given an opportunity to be the first in the country to develop a system such as Agni. A great opportunity has been given to us. Natural y major opportunities are accompanied by equal y major chal enges. We should not give up and we should not al ow the problem to defeat us. The country doesn’t deserve anything less than success from us. Let us aim for success”. I had almost completed my address, when I found myself tel ing my people, “I promise you, we wil be back after successful y launching Agni before the end of this month.”